

Word family: **delay / delays / delayed / delaying**

Base word: delay

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

* **delay** (n.) — 延誤；延遲；耽擱

* **delay** (v.) — 延誤；延遲；耽擱

* **delayed** (adj./participle) — 延誤的；延遲的

* **delaying** (gerund/participle) — 正在延誤 / 拖延

* **delay in** —方面的延誤

* **delay to** — 對.....造成延誤 (較少見，視結構而定)

* **without delay** — 毫不耽擱；立即

* **long delay / slight delay / unexpected delay** — 長時間 / 輕微 / 意外延誤

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **cause a delay**

* **experience a delay**

* **face a delay**

* **a delay in something**

* **a delay of two hours**

* **without delay**

* **delay a project**

* **delay a decision**

* **delay doing something**

* **delay someone**

* **be delayed**

* **delayed flight**

* **developmental delay**

* **time delay**

* **delay line / delay effect** in technical contexts

Meaning in this passage

> Kevin apologised to me because he had blamed me unfairly for **delaying the project**.

Here, **delaying** means:

causing the project to progress more slowly or finish later than planned — 拖慢；延誤

Kevin wrongly believed that the speaker had failed to upload their part and was therefore making the whole project run late.

****中文翻譯：****

Kevin 之所以向我道歉，是因為他曾經不公平地怪責我****拖慢了小組進度****。

So here:

**delay something = 令某件事比原定時間更遲發生、完成或向前推進**

1. **delay something — 延誤；拖慢某事**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He blamed me for ****delaying the project****.

他怪責我****拖慢了項目進度****。

Practice 2

> Technical problems ****delayed the launch****.

技術問題****延誤了推出日期****。

Practice 3

> The missing file ****delayed the presentation****.

缺少的檔案****拖慢了簡報準備****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****delay something = 令某件事比原定時間更遲開始、進行或完成****

2. **delay a project — 延誤項目**

Practice 1

> Poor communication can ****delay a project****.

溝通不良可以****拖慢項目進度****。

Practice 2

> The weather **delayed the project** by several days.

天氣令項目**延誤了幾天**。

MCQ-ready definition:

delay a project = 令項目不能按原定進度進行或完成

3. **delay a decision** — 延遲作決定

Practice 1

> They decided to **delay the decision** until next week.

他們決定把決定**押後到下星期**。

Practice 2

> We shouldn't **delay the decision** any longer.

我們不應再**拖延作決定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

delay a decision = 把原本應該較早作出的決定推遲

4. **delay doing something** — 延遲做某事

Practice 1

> Don't **delay sending the email**.

不要**拖延發電郵**。

Practice 2

> She **delayed making a decision**.

她**遲遲沒有作決定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

delay doing X = 把做 X 的時間推遲

5. **delay someone — 耽誤某人**

Practice 1

> Sorry to **delay you**.

不好意思**耽誤你**。

Practice 2

> The traffic **delayed us** by an hour.

交通令我們**耽誤了一小時**。

MCQ-ready definition:

delay someone = 令某人不能按原定時間前進或到達

6. **be delayed — 被延誤**

Practice 1

> The flight was **delayed**.

航班**延誤了**。

Practice 2

> The meeting was **delayed by thirty minutes**.

會議**延遲了三十分鐘**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be delayed = 比原定時間遲開始、到達或完成

7. **delayed flight / train — 延誤航班 / 列車**

Practice 1

> Our flight was **delayed** because of bad weather.

我們的航班因惡劣天氣而**延誤**。

Practice 2

> The **delayed train** finally arrived.

那班**延誤的列車**終於到達。

MCQ-ready definition:

delayed transport = 比原定時間遲出發或到達的交通工具

8. **delay (noun : 延誤 ; 耽擱) — 延誤 ; 拖延**

Practice 1

> There was a long **delay**.

出現了長時間**延誤**。

Practice 2

> We apologized for the **delay**.

我們為**延誤**道歉。

MCQ-ready definition:

delay = 某件事沒有按原定時間發生或完成的情況

9. **a delay in something —方面的延誤**

Practice 1

> There was a **delay in production**.

生產出現了**延誤**。

Practice 2

> A **delay in communication** caused confusion.

溝通上的**延誤**造成混亂。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a delay in X = X 的進度或處理時間比原定慢****

10. ****a delay of X time — 延誤 X 時間****

Practice 1

> There was a ****delay of two hours****.

出現了****兩小時延誤****。

Practice 2

> The accident caused a ****delay of twenty minutes****.

意外造成****二十分鐘延誤****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a delay of X = 比原定時間遲了 X 的時間長度****

11. ****cause a delay — 造成延誤****

Practice 1

> The missing document ****caused a delay****.

缺少文件****造成了延誤****。

Practice 2

> Roadworks may ****cause delays****.

道路工程可能會****造成延誤****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****cause a delay = 令事情不能按原定時間進行****

12. ****experience / face a delay — 遇到延誤****

Practice 1

> Passengers **experienced a delay**.

乘客**遇到延誤**。

Practice 2

> The project **faced several delays**.

項目**遇到幾次延誤**。

MCQ-ready definition:

experience/face a delay = 遇到比預期更慢或更遲的情況

13. **without delay — 毫不耽擱；立即**

Practice 1

> Please respond **without delay**.

請**立即回覆**。

Practice 2

> The problem needs to be fixed **without delay**.

問題需要**馬上處理**。

MCQ-ready definition:

without delay = 不再等待或拖延，立即做

14. **unexpected delay — 意外延誤**

Practice 1

> An **unexpected delay** affected the schedule.

一次**意外延誤**影響了時間表。

Practice 2

> We apologized for the **unexpected delay**.

我們為**突如其來的延誤**道歉。

MCQ-ready definition:

unexpected delay = 原先沒有預料到的延誤

15. **slight / short delay — 輕微 / 短暫延誤**

Practice 1

> There may be a **slight delay**.

可能有**輕微延誤**。

Practice 2

> After a **short delay**, the meeting began.

短暫**延誤**後，會議開始了。

MCQ-ready definition:

slight/short delay = 時間不長、影響較小的延誤

16. **long / significant delay — 長時間 / 重大延誤**

Practice 1

> The repairs caused a **significant delay**.

維修造成了**重大延誤**。

Practice 2

> There was a **long delay** at the airport.

機場出現了長時間**延誤**。

MCQ-ready definition:

long/significant delay = 時間較長或影響較大的延誤

17. **delay (推遲某事件) — 延期 ; 押後**

Practice 1

> They **delayed the meeting** until Friday.

他們把會議**押後到星期五**。

Practice 2

> The match was **delayed by rain**.

比賽因下雨而**延遲**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****delay an event = 把原定舉行時間推遲至較後****

18. **delay vs postpone — 延誤 vs 押後**

Closely related but not identical.

delay

something starts/finishes later, intentionally or unintentionally.

postpone

a deliberate decision to move an event to a later time.

> The storm **delayed** the flight.

> 暴風令航班延誤。

> They **postponed** the meeting until Monday.

> 他們把會議押後至星期一。

19. **delay vs hold up — 延誤 vs 耽誤**

delay

neutral, broad.

hold up

more informal and often emphasizes something actively blocking progress.

> Traffic delayed us.

交通令我們延誤。

> Traffic held us up.

交通把我們**耽擱住了**。

20. **delay vs hold back — 延誤 vs 阻礙進度**

Very relevant to your passage.

delay

make something late.

hold back

prevent progress or development more broadly.

> delay the project

> 令項目遲了

> hold the team back

> 阻礙團隊前進

Kevin accuses the speaker of both ideas in effect:

* **holding everyone back**

* **delaying the project**

21. **delay vs wait**

wait

someone intentionally stays until something happens.

delay

something happens later than planned.

> I waited for the train.

我等火車。

> The train was delayed.

火車延誤。

Completely different direction.

22. **delay vs late**

delay

noun/verb describing the cause or event.

late

adjective/adverb describing timing.

> There was a delay.

有延誤。

> The train was late.

火車遲了。

23. **delay vs deadline**

deadline

latest acceptable time.

delay

being later than planned.

> deadline = 截止日期

> delay = 延誤

Missing a deadline may be caused by a delay, but they are not the same concept.

24. **delayed reaction / response — 延遲反應**

A common figurative/technical extension.

Practice 1

> The medicine may cause a **delayed reaction**.

藥物可能引起**延遲反應**。

Practice 2

> There was a **delayed response** to the announcement.

對公告的反應出現了**延遲**。

MCQ-ready definition:

delayed reaction/response = 並非即時出現，而是在一段時間後才發生的反應

25. **delayed effect — 延遲效應**

Practice 1

> The policy may have a **delayed effect**.

這項政策可能有**延遲效應**。

Practice 2

> Some treatments have **delayed effects**.

有些治療會產生**延後出現的效果**。

MCQ-ready definition:

delayed effect = 原因出現後過一段時間才產生的效果

26. ****developmental delay — 發展遲緩****

A medical/educational compound.

Practice 1

> The child was assessed for ****developmental delay****.

孩子接受了****發展遲緩****評估。

Practice 2

> Early support may help children with ****developmental delays****.

早期支援可能幫助有****發展遲緩****的兒童。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****developmental delay = 兒童在某些發展範疇達到里程碑的時間明顯較預期遲****

27. ****time delay — 時延；時間延遲****

A technical/common compound.

Practice 1

> There is a short ****time delay**** in the signal.

訊號有短暫****時延****。

Practice 2

> The broadcast has a few seconds of ****delay****.

直播有幾秒****延遲****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****time delay = 訊號、動作、反應等從發生到被接收之間的時間差****

Important distinction 1: ****delay something vs delay doing something****

****delay + noun****

> delay the meeting

把會議延遲

delay + -ing

> delay making a decision

延遲作決定

Do not normally use:

> *delay to make a decision* ❌

Important distinction 2: **be delayed by vs delayed for**

Cause:

> delayed **by traffic**

因交通而延誤

Duration:

> delayed **for two hours**

延誤了兩小時

This is a very useful grammar distinction.

Important distinction 3: **delay by X time vs delay until X time**

delay by two hours

推遲兩小時

delay until Friday

推遲至星期五

One expresses amount; the other expresses new endpoint.

Important distinction 4: **cause a delay vs be delayed**

Cause:

> The missing file caused a delay.

缺少檔案造成延誤。

Result:

> The project was delayed.

項目被延誤。

Important distinction 5: **delay vs cancel**

delay

still expected to happen, but later.

cancel

will not happen as planned at all.

> delayed flight

> 延誤航班

> cancelled flight

> 取消航班

Important distinction 6: **delay vs reschedule**

delay

push later, sometimes without a clear new time.

reschedule

assign a new scheduled time/date.

A delayed meeting may later be rescheduled.

Important distinction 7: **delay** vs **defer**

delay

general everyday word.

defer

more formal, often deliberately postpone a decision, payment, or action.

> defer payment

> 延期付款

> delay payment

> 延遲付款

Both possible, but register differs.

Important distinction 8: **delay** vs **procrastinate**

delay

simply make something later.

procrastinate

habitually or unnecessarily put off doing something you should do.

> The storm delayed us.

暴風令我們延誤。

> I procrastinated and didn't start the essay.

我拖延症發作，遲遲沒有開始作文。

So **delay** does not necessarily imply laziness.

Important distinction 9: ****delay someone vs make someone wait****

****delay someone****

cause them to be late or held up.

****make someone wait****

cause them to spend time waiting.

They overlap, but:

> traffic delayed us

> 交通令我們遲到

does not necessarily mean we were literally standing still waiting.

Important distinction 10: ****delayed response vs slow response****

****delayed response****

response occurs later than expected.

****slow response****

response itself may take time or be sluggish.

Not always identical.

Family-extension note

****Delay**** has a strong, stable semantic core:

****make something happen later than expected or planned****

That branches into:

1. ****verb: make something late****

* delay a project

* delay a meeting

2. **verb: put off an action**

* delay making a decision

3. **noun: the late period/event**

* a delay

* a two-hour delay

4. **transport and scheduling**

* delayed flight

* schedule delay

5. **response/effect timing**

* delayed reaction

* delayed effect

6. **development/technical timing**

* developmental delay

* time delay

For your passage, the exact meaning is:

delay the project = cause the group's work to progress or finish later than planned

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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delay (verb)	延誤；拖慢	make late
delay a project	拖慢項目	slow progress
delay a decision	延遲決定	postpone choice
delay doing X	延遲做 X	put off action
delay someone	耽誤某人	make someone late
be delayed	被延誤	happen late
delayed flight	延誤航班	transport
delay (noun)	延誤；耽擱	late period
delay in X	X 的延誤	affected process
delay of two hours	延誤兩小時	duration
cause a delay	造成延誤	produce lateness
experience a delay	遇到延誤	encounter lateness

without delay	立即；毫不耽擱	no waiting	
unexpected delay	意外延誤	unplanned	
slight delay	輕微延誤	short	
significant delay	重大延誤	major	
delayed reaction	延遲反應	later response	
delayed effect	延遲效應	later effect	
developmental delay	發展遲緩	developmental timing	
time delay	時延	time lag	

For your original sentence

> Kevin apologised to me because he had blamed me unfairly for **delaying the project**.

Here:

delaying the project = 令整個小組的工作比原定進度更慢、更遲完成

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> Kevin 之所以向我道歉，是因為他曾經不公平地怪責我**拖慢了小組進度**。

The most useful contrast here is:

> **delay the project** = 令項目遲了

> **hold everyone back** = 阻礙大家向前推進

They overlap strongly in this passage, but **delay** emphasizes **lateness**, while **hold back** emphasizes **blocked progress**.